



Pebble beast

Chalicotherium means “pebble beast.” The animal was so named because the first fossil teeth looked like pebbles. When *Chalicotherium* became an adult, it shed the teeth at the front of its mouth, leaving only fleshy lips and gums to strip leaves from branches. Mouthfuls of leaves were then ground to a pulp with teeth at the back of the mouth.

◀ **NUCKLE WALKER** *This animal's front legs were much longer than its hind legs. Each front leg ended in long, curved claws, which meant that Chalicotherium couldn't place its foot flat on the ground. So, it probably shuffled along on its knuckles, just like gorillas do today.*

